

Ulysses Grant, IV

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Professional Summary

Senior Platform & DevOps Engineer with 15+ years of experience designing, deploying, and optimizing enterprise-scale cloud infrastructure, CI/CD pipelines, and site reliability solutions. Proven expertise in Azure, Infrastructure as Code (IaC), CI/CD automation, and observability practices to improve system reliability, reduce deployment times, and enable high-velocity software delivery. Skilled in SRE principles (SLIs/SLOs), cloud migration, and platform modernization with a track record of delivering measurable business outcomes for SaaS and enterprise clients.

Core Competencies

- **Cloud & Infrastructure:** Azure (IaaS, PaaS, SaaS), VMware, Hybrid Cloud, App Modernization
- **DevOps & SRE:** CI/CD Automation, Incident Management, Observability (SLIs/SLOs), Chaos Engineering
- **IaC & Automation:** Terraform, Bicep, Ansible, ARM Templates, PowerShell, Bash, Python
- **Containers & Orchestration:** Docker, Kubernetes (AKS)
- **Monitoring & Reliability:** Prometheus, Grafana, Application Insights, Log Analytics
- **Version Control & SCM:** GitHub, GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps, Jenkins
- **Security & Governance:** GitHub Advanced Security (GHAS), SOX/IT Audit Compliance, NIST Frameworks
- **Methodologies:** Agile, SAFE, ITIL

Professional Experience

InCycle Software

Jan 2022 - Present

Senior Platform & DevOps Engineer

- Designed and implemented multi-environment Azure cloud platforms, leveraging Terraform, Bicep, and Ansible to reduce provisioning time by 30% and improve reliability.
- Built and optimized CI/CD pipelines with Azure DevOps and GitHub Actions, reducing time-to-market by 40% and improving deployment quality.
- Architected and executed a cloud migration strategy for enterprise clients, moving critical workloads to Azure IaaS and PaaS while ensuring alignment with NIST 800 compliance requirements.
- Established SRE-driven observability practices using Application Insights, Log Analytics, and Grafana to define SLIs/SLOs, improving mean time to detection (MTTD) by 35%.
- Led technical pre-sales engineering and solution architecture, contributing to three enterprise project wins by delivering proof-of-concepts and client workshops.
- Enhanced client adoption of platform services by 20% by aligning business goals with modern platform capabilities and demonstrating measurable value.

AvidXchange, Inc.

Dec 2020 - Jan 2022

Platform Engineer – DevOps & Cloud Automation

- Engineered Azure platform designs to support enterprise financial applications, reducing deployment cycles by 25%
- Developed and standardized Terraform IaC modules for infrastructure deployments across development, staging, and production environments.
- Authored automation scripts using Python and PowerShell to streamline routine operational tasks and CI/CD pipeline validation, reducing manual intervention.
- Troubleshooted and resolved 50+ complex Azure DevOps pipeline issues, improving CI/CD reliability and release efficiency.
- Supported containerized applications on Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS), collaborating with development teams to troubleshoot pod deployments and ensure service reliability.
- Resolved over 50 complex Azure DevOps pipeline issues, and led root cause analysis (RCA) for automation failures, which improved overall pipeline stability by 90%.

Chevron

Jan 2018 - Dec 2020

DevOps Engineer

Houston, TX

- Designed and managed CI/CD pipelines in Azure DevOps (VSTS/TFS), reducing build times by 20% through optimized PowerShell, Bash scripts, and Artifactory configurations.
- Automated Azure IaaS and SaaS deployments with ADO and Ansible, improving efficiency and reducing migration time by 25%.
- Implemented and configured monitoring dashboards using Prometheus and Grafana to track infrastructure health and pipeline metrics, improving visibility for engineering teams.
- Maintained 99.9% pipeline uptime, which improved deployment lead times by 30% for over 10 development teams.
- Supported SOX and IT audit readiness by documenting and enforcing compliance controls within the CI/CD process.

Chevron

Jan 2017 - Jan 2018

Team Lead - ITSM Process Advisor / TCOE Coordinator (COE Trading

Houston, TX

- Directed a six-member development team executing unit testing for Supply & Trading applications, strengthening release quality and reducing production defects.

- Led the ITSM process advisory function for the Supply & Trading business unit, ensuring alignment to governance and best practices.
- Coordinated the Center of Excellence (TCOE/COE) to drive process standardization and maturity across ITSM functions.
- Defined and maintained process frameworks, including incident, problem, change, and release management workflows tailored to Supply & Trading.
- Developed and rolled out training playbooks for process owners and stakeholders, reducing onboarding time by 30% and improving adoption.
- Partnered with stakeholders to assess process gaps, recommend improvements, and monitor KPIs, leading to measurable gains in process efficiency.

Chevron

Sep 2013 - Jan 2017

IT Major Incident Coordinator

Houston, TX

Acted as the single point of contact for high-severity outages, coordinating incident bridges with 50+ technical teams and senior stakeholders.

- Participated in 24x7x365 shift coverage to support Chevron's critical IT Infrastructure, Middleware, and Applications, ensuring timely incident response and engagement of support groups, which enhanced incident resolution efficiency
- Stayed current on industry trends in IT Reliability, proactive/predictive monitoring, metrics, FMEA, RCA, Analytical Troubleshooting, Knowledge Management, and ITIL, which contributed to improved incident management strategies
- Owned the end-to-end incident lifecycle, including detection, triage, escalation, resolution, and business communication, which led to faster incident resolution times and improved service reliability
- Implemented real-time communication protocols that improved transparency and stakeholder trust during outages.
- Partnered with engineering and operations teams to analyze root causes, track remediation efforts, and enforce accountability.
- Maintained precise documentation for SOX and IT controls to support compliance and audit readiness.
- Conducted Quality Assurance Reviews on a cross-section of IT RCA Investigations regularly, ensuring thorough analysis and continuous improvement in incident management processes

Shell Oil

Nov 2008 - Sep 2013

IT Consultant / Analyst

Houston, TX

- Consulted across 20+ departments, improving operational efficiency by 15% through technology upgrades and IT solutions.
- Created and implemented comprehensive troubleshooting protocols by leveraging Bash scripting and GitHub Actions, which improved operational efficiency and decreased system downtime by 25%.
- Provided technical support and network administration for the 2nd largest US trading floor, resolving network connectivity issues, running server patch releases, reviewing server system logs, performing upgrades, and monitoring server health using Nagios, resulting in improved system reliability
- Supported and monitored real-time trading applications such as Reuters, CQG, The Ice, and Bloomberg, ensuring seamless operation and minimizing downtime, which enhanced trading efficiency and reduced operational disruptions
- Built client Citrix profiles, managed access levels, and controlled and monitored XenApp sessions, enhancing user access management and system performance, leading to improved user satisfaction and reduced access-related issues

Education

Virginia Tech

2013 - 2016

Master's Degree, Information Technology

University of Arkansas

2001 - 2006

Bachelor's Degree, Management & Information Systems

Certifications

- **Microsoft Azure Administrator:**Renewal 2026
- **Microsoft Azure AI Engineer Associate:**Renewal 2025
- **Microsoft Data Fabric Engineer:**Renewal 2026
- **Windows Server Hybrid Administrator:**Renewal 2026
- **GitHub Advanced Security:**Renewal 2027